

The Father Has Life in Himself

When we begin this one, we will begin again with John 5:26. I want to remind you that when God introduced the Born-Again Trail from the fifth chapter of John, the twenty-sixth verse, one of the questions I communed back with Him was this:

"Where are the key verses to walking in the kind of power You said is available through Your Word? These signs shall follow them that believe. You can say to the mountain, and nothing shall be impossible to you. The works I do shall you do also."

He said, "It is in most of the verses that people leave out, mostly because they do not understand them, yet they are major keys."

Like this one:

"For as the Father hath life in himself;
so hath he given to the Son to have life in himself."

This is definitely a verse that is left out a lot. In fact, most of the verses leading up to it in John 5 are left out a lot. One of them is preached in funerals quite a bit, the verse just before John 5:26:

"Verily, verily, I say unto you,
The hour is coming, and now is,
when the dead shall hear the voice of the Son of God:
and they that hear shall live."

That is preached at funerals, where they say, "Be of good cheer," because they know the person was a believer. But in the next verse He says, "For as the Father hath life in himself; so hath he given to the Son to have life in himself."

The verse preceding that is the fulfilling of the promise God made to Abraham. God said, "Can you believe I can quicken the dead?" Abraham stood before Him who quickens the dead, that is, who brings a spirit from death to life. God said, "Can you believe I can do that, Abraham?"

Abraham said, "Yes, I do."

God said, "Good, because now righteousness is to your account. It is accounted to you to be paid in full at My resurrection."

That is what He is talking about. "The hour now is when the dead shall hear the voice of the Son of Man, and they that hear shall live." That is every person with accounted righteousness waiting for the Firstborn to be born. All of those who heard His voice would live.

He is not talking about you coming out of the grave there. He is talking about emptying Abraham's bosom, giving them the new nature, and leading a great procession on to heaven.

That is why the next verse says, "For as the Father hath life in himself, so hath he given to the Son to have life in himself." And the Son gave to us. That life, which began its journey in the Father, ended up in the Son, and has now ended up in you and me.

We were quickened together with Him and seated in heavenly places. The same life Jesus was quickened back to life with, after He gave Himself over to death, is the same life we received when we were quickened together with Him and seated.

That same life began its journey in the Father. "For as the Father hath life in himself," Jesus found that life in His human spirit when He was born. He died and was quickened back to that life again. That life He was quickened back to is the life we were quickened to when we were quickened together with Him and seated in heavenly places.

One more time: as the Father hath life within Himself, He gave to the Son to have life within Himself. That same life that was in the Son is now in you, because you are quickened together with Him.

Notice that He says, "As the Father hath life." The word "hath" is present tense, but it is much more than present tense. It is past tense forever, and forward tense forever. It carries the same weight as when God told Moses who He was.

Moses said, "Whom shall I say to Pharaoh has sent me?"

God said, "Tell him that I AM has sent you."

I AM is simply the sum total of everything that is, was, or ever will be. That is who I AM is. When Paul was teaching on faith in Hebrews 11, he said, "He that cometh to God must believe that he is." That is the same thing as the name of God. You come to Him; you must believe that He is. He is who He said He is. He said, "I AM," everything that is, was, or ever will be, past, present, and future.

He is telling you where your life came from. As the Father hath life in Himself, that life has always existed, exists now, and forever will exist. The same life that began its journey in the Father, and found itself in the humanity of Jesus in His human spirit, was crucified, for He was given over to death so that we might be quickened together with Him. Now that same life that began in the Father, was in the Son, is now in you.

People say, "God created man." Yes, but let me tell you how. I was not there. Before I was there, I did not exist. Now I am here, and I exist. In that manner of speaking, yes, He created me because I was not there and then I was here.

But the way He created me and created you is the same way you created your sons and daughters. They were not there, and then they were there. So yes, they were created, but not in the sense of something that did not exist and had to be created from nothing in order to exist.

That is the difference between being born and being created. We were born from a life that already existed, our Father. "For as the Father hath life in himself," that is the life I was born from. It came from God. It already existed, just as your children were born from the life you already had.

They were not there, and then they were. In that sense of the word, they were created. But the more accurate way to say it is that they were born. The difference between you and an angel is that an angel was literally created. Not you. You were born. God has become your Father.

There is a teaching going around because some preacher went to heaven and said he saw a place where little baby spirits are created, and then at a certain time they are sent to earth, I guess to embody the embryo, or maybe at the moment of conception. He said he saw this place where little human spirits are created.

But if God were going to create your little spirit alive in heaven, He would just keep it there. That is the whole point. We are born spiritually dead, and God came to redeem us so we could go there. We are not born spiritually alive there, then sent here to die and take our chances with hell.

Our spirit comes into existence through the law of Genesis, which is beginnings. When Jesus was talking to Nicodemus, He said:

"That which is born of the flesh is flesh;
and that which is born of the Spirit is spirit.
Ye must be born again."

A better interpretation is "born from above." When He said, "That which is born of the flesh is flesh," He was saying your first birth is when your spirit came into operation or existence through flesh, producing flesh. In other words, if your father is Adam, then you were born spiritually dead.

Your first birth of flesh is when that little spirit came into existence. But then I have been born again. Jesus told Nicodemus, "You have already been born of flesh. You do not enter your mother's womb a second time and be born again. I am talking about a birth that is from above. You must be born from above. What is born of flesh is flesh, and what is born of Spirit is spirit."

The part of you that must be born from above is your human spirit.

In this Born-Again Trail, so much has come online. God has become so much my Father. I can see now where those miracles live. The water is troubled, and I am putting my foot in it a little bit. I see in my wildest dreams white eyes, no eyes, and the possibility of that is getting so strong in my spirit I can hardly stand it.

Those keys are on the Born-Again Trail. When God plunged me into Him as my Father, little did I know what a major key that was to inheritance, supply, and absolute signs and wonders.

What a statement: "Call no man on this earth father." Of course I have an earthly father of my flesh. Of course I have an earthly father of my first birth. Of course I have an earthly father in the sense that I did not exist, and then suddenly I existed. I was not there, and then I was. You could

say I was created, but it would be more accurate to say I was born.

You could say God created you, but it would be more accurate to say you were born, because you were born of a life that has always existed inside the Father.

This is why, when He created Adam's body and held him up, there was nothing but a corpse. Then He breathed into him the breaths of life, and Adam became a living soul. Do you think God is dependent on His own creation? Do you think He is dependent on air? Do you think God's body consumes oxygen to stay alive? Do you really think He breathes?

God blew into Adam, and He used that to let you know He reached inside Himself where that life lived and breathed into Adam. The same life that was in Him was transferred into Adam. Adam's spirit was born.

This is why, when Jesus was explaining it to Nicodemus, He said, "Nicodemus, you must be born again."

Nicodemus asked, "How can this be?"

Jesus answered the question. He not only answered it, He told him how it would happen, but Nicodemus missed all of it. Jesus said, "The wind bloweth where it listeth, and thou hearest the sound thereof, but canst not tell whence it cometh, and whither it goeth: so is every man that is born of the Spirit."

The word "wind" is the same as breath. He was saying the Holy Spirit is present everywhere, like the wind. When a person bows the knee, the same thing that happened in Adam the first time happens again. Your old spiritually dead spirit is born again, and that life comes from God just like it came into the first man Adam.

That is why you can trace the bloodline from Adam down to Joseph, and then Joseph was no more the father of Jesus than Adam is the father of your new life. Joseph never touched Mary. The Holy Spirit overshadowed Mary, and Jesus was born. His birth was from above.

Your bloodline goes from Adam to Noah, and every one of us is a child of Ham, Shem, or Japheth. Every one of us has more DNA from one of those three fathers. You can look at the human race and see differences in the physical man and know that characteristics came from one of those fathers. Ham is basically the father of the Egyptians, Japheth of the Greeks, and Shem of the Jews and Arabs. The DNA took off in different directions, and then we became isolated.

You can trace that bloodline from Adam all the way down to you. Then, all of a sudden, you bowed your knee to the Lord Jesus Christ and were born from above. Now Adam is no more your father than Joseph was Jesus' father, because you have been born from above.

I got into all of that for a reason. As the Father hath life within Himself, with no past and no future, always is, always was, and always will be, that is the life I have been born from.

You are so individual. If they took a strand of your hair, got the DNA out of it, and traced you back to Adam, then checked every person's DNA that has ever lived, even identical twins, when you get right down to the last molecule, there would be a difference. You are not like any other person on this planet who has ever lived. You are that individual.

If you are that individual by your first birth, how individual do you think you are when you were born from above? I am just beginning to realize that it is my individuality God is after in fellowship.

We tend to group ourselves together as a corporate body. You may think God is sitting in heaven looking at you as just one individual in a large mass of people, that He is looking at us corporately and does not pay much attention to us individually. Wrong.

You are going to be gathered around Him for billions and billions of years. Do you think He does not have time to be individual?

How many children do you have? Are they all different from each other? Do you have time to be individual with each one? One child does not give you the same fellowship as the next one, and that next one does not give you the same fellowship as the next. One thing is sure: they fill your life up.

Think of your individuality. What do you have to give Him? He wanted something from us. He created us, born us as His family, to gather us around Him forever. Even in your first birth you are such an individual, different from anyone who has ever lived.

In my family, all my sons and my daughter are different from each other. I get something from each one that is different from the others. Some of them give me as many problems as Adam gave God, but nevertheless, here is your Father. He has made us His sons and daughters. What He wants from us is the individuality and fellowship we can give Him.

You are as individual to Him as a person standing alone, with no other one ever created or born anywhere. You have that capacity to be individual to Him, and it is that individuality you can give Him in your relationship and worship.

When I crawled into that closet of mine and began to worship Him hour after hour, I found out He is deriving fellowship and pleasure from that which He can get from no other human being on this earth, because I am His son and I am individual. You are His son or daughter, and you are that individual.

As the Father hath life within Himself, He gave to the Son to have life within Himself, and the Son gave to you to have that same life within yourself.

As this revelation of my Father keeps unfolding to me, it is the strangest thing. I get to stand in the presence of those miracles, especially with people who are unaccountable. You stagger into the service and wonder, "Who is God?" I get to stand in the presence. I can feel that faith, the moving of the Spirit, and that love and confidence coming from somewhere it has never come from before.

I can feel the miracle. I can see it. I think our town is in trouble. I go beyond believing it. I know our town is in trouble. Hallelujah. In trouble, in trouble, in trouble.

We have messed the word worship up. He is my Father, and He is also my God. In the truest sense, I am His child. He calls us children more than once. He is my Father. I am His child. Yet He is my God.

Where we have messed worship up is that idolatry and the children of Ham, Shem, and Japheth have overspread the earth. They have killed and sacrificed their own children. They have built idols and worshiped creation. The worship we derive our word from often comes from idolatrous races who worshiped something they feared, not the reverent kind of fear you have for your God who is your Father, but a sacrificial kind of fear that keeps a god appeased.

But when He said He seeks such to worship Him in spirit and in truth, that phrase encompassed the whole idea that you have become His son and He is seeking that relationship out of you. That is finally possible because you have been born again and have His nature.

Now your whole life can be full of fellowship with Him, not just the idea of worship that comes from your lips and adoration, but a whole life of fellowship, of walking with Him as Father, worshiping Him, and demonstrating Him to a world going under because you know Him as Father.

He sought you out for this kind of fellowship, and you are giving it to Him.

I finally understand what He wanted from me. I could not understand creation. He created us, and then we fell. A self-sustaining, all-encompassing God who has no need came after us. What does He want you and me for, especially when we caused Him so much trouble?

I finally understand. I am as individual to Him as my sons and daughter are to me. I get a fellowship from each of them that is different from the other. Just because God has billions and billions of children, do you think He does not have time to be individual with you? What do you think He wanted a family for?

As quickly as He could, He got you back. You may have been born of the flesh the first time, the Adamic race that had fallen, but not the second time. The second time you were born from above. That journey of life had to come from the Father, go through Jesus, and fall directly on you from above. The moment you bowed your knee, you became a son of God, linked with your Father in fellowship with Him.

He wants your fellowship with Him to be just as rich now as it will be the day you step into His presence in heaven with a glorified body, with no veil of flesh between you and Him.

Who is going to do the exploits? Who will get to see white eyes swirl until pupils are formed? Who is going to hear the screams and shrieks of little children who walk for the first time and are let out of the prison of their bodies? It will be those who know and begin to understand the compassion of the Father, who wants this fellowship with you more than you wanted it with Him.

Early in the Born-Again Trail, we made the statement that the covenant God made with Abraham resulted in our sonship. Basically, we no longer have a covenant in the same sense; we are sons and daughters of God and have an inheritance.

That may have set people on a trip more than almost anything else on the Born-Again Trail. The hardest thing for people to get past was understanding that the covenant He cut with Abraham--"In thy seed shall all the nations of the earth be blessed"--resulted in our sonship. So it is not the same. We are literally sons and daughters of God.

Understanding adoption helped me a lot. God sealed it for me by asking whether I would treat Daniel and Tawny, my adopted son and daughter, any differently as far as inheritance is concerned than I would treat David, Bill, and Steve.

I said, "No, I would not."

He said, "What if they got out their adoption papers, the covenant you entered into with the people you were adopting them from, every time they wanted to ask you for something?"

I said, "They would probably get the worst correction they ever got in their life."

Once the adoption process is complete, there is absolutely no difference. They are bone of your bone and flesh of your flesh. David especially does not get out a binding agreement when he comes into the house and raids the refrigerator. He comes by inheritance and just raids it. They carry things off by the boatloads. Daniel and Tawny have absolutely the same rights. There is no difference.

That adoption that made us sons resulted because of a covenant God made with Abraham. When we got to Romans 8 on adoption, which is what we are dealing with in Galatians now, Paul said:

"Ye have not received the spirit of bondage again to fear;
but ye have received the Spirit of adoption."

The human spirit has been adopted by God through the change of natures. His Spirit bears witness with ours that we are the children of God. If children, then heirs; heirs of God, and joint heirs with Christ.

I am an heir of God, and I am a joint heir with Jesus Christ. In the Jewish family, the oldest brother inherits the fortune of the father. Jesus was the Firstborn in our family, the oldest living Brother. He inherited all the Father had. What makes this so good is that He made us joint heirs with Him.

The next scheduled supernatural event in God's sovereignty for us who have the firstfruits of the Spirit is the completion of the adoption process: the redemption of our bodies. Jesus rose from the dead and laid one glorified body to our account. He inherited the glorified body, and I am a joint heir with Him.

That is the next scheduled sovereign event. I can believe all I want for it, and it will not come before its time. It is going to come when it comes. There is nothing I can do about that except make sure I let the Holy Spirit seal me in such a way that the world will never claim me again. Then I will have that glorified body in a moment, in the twinkling of an eye.

That is a good-looking glorified body. Too bad you do not still marry and stuff. If your faith does not get you married before you get to heaven, do not try it there.

In this inheritance, God has seated us in heavenly places with Christ Jesus. The Holy Spirit bears witness with our spirit that we are His children. Here on this earth, this outpost, I am an ambassador. I have been left here for reconciliation.

Pertaining to redemption, reward, and the things He has for us to do, we are seated in our spirit in heavenly places in authority in Christ Jesus. We have all the rights of a son here for inheritance. He has made us free. To carry on the work of redemption, we have all the rights of inheritance.

I like what Gary has been teaching. Just as we call this the Born-Again Trail, Gary calls his prosperity teaching "the rights of the inner man and his inheritance." In his vision, he saw a golden man, definitely different from the body, so Gary entitled it "the golden man."

In that teaching, he differentiated between provision and the pound. I had taught for many years from Luke 17 that the slave who worked in the field all day would not come in and say, "Feed me, master." The master would say, "No, first feed me, and then you may sit down and eat from my table." Jesus said the master would not even thank him, because he had done what a class-A servant is supposed to do: serve the master first, and then eat from the master's table.

Gary brought several other parables into it, and when he did, it cleared up a lot of the in-between parts. The pound is what God came back to get with interest. Provision is the promise God has for a slave who can sit down at His table and eat. His needs will always be supplied. Whatever it takes for you to get by, and more, will always be supplied.

But the pound belongs to God. In Gary's teaching he began to say, "Do not touch the pound."

Gary has given more in the first quarter of this year than he gave in all of last year, and he is a giver. The problem with greed is the way we have preached the blessings: ten percent is God's and ninety percent is ours. That is not what Jesus said. He said, "When you have done all, say, 'We are unprofitable slaves. We have done what was our duty to do.'"

When Gary taught on this, he calculated his bills and found out what it took him to get by. That was his provision. Everything over the provision was the pound God gave him for the kingdom of God. That is where greed is murdered. Greed is put on the cross.

Gary knows what his provision is. Anything over that is pound, and he has already consecrated the pound to God. That is what he brings in from the field before he sits down and eats at the master's table.

The way we often teach prosperity, we keep the ninety percent, and God gets the ten percent of the increase. God increases, and we consume the ninety percent. But if this is the amount you have prayed and separated for provision, then anything that comes over it is pound.

When the first check came in, temptation rose in Gary, because he could have used some carpet and other things. But it was over the provision, so it was pound.

If a man is dead, God knows He can send a million dollars in. You may drool over the million, but it is pound. When God knew that Gary knew and had died enough, things began to happen. Where he used to go to the mailbox and get twenties, people started sending hundreds. People who never sent anything started sending thousands. A stock he had bought and then left alone went up. When pound became pound and provision became provision, things shifted.

If you want a little more provision, do you think God has a problem with that? He is not living any less than He did. Do you think an honest Master such as the Lord Jesus Christ is going to treat you badly, slight you, or cheat you? He is going to treat you and your family well.

The problem is trusting us with the rest of it, because most of it does not go to the kingdom of God.

We have an incredible inheritance. I am God's son. I am His son and a joint heir with Jesus Christ. But the goal of my heart as His son is to go from minister of heavenly things, which is servant, to slave. I want my Father to know that even though I am His son, I know I have an awful lot of family that was lost. In this part of my inheritance, my Father has asked me to join myself with Him to search for those lost in our family tree and bring them back home.

That is my goal in this life. In eternity, this may be the single most important thing He will ever ask me to do, and I refuse to waste one moment of it.

Romans 8 says that when we were born again, our spirits went from death to life. We do not have the spirit of the world anymore. The spirit that has been adopted by God received His nature. The Holy Spirit bears witness with ours that we are His children. If children, then heirs of God and joint heirs with Christ. Then Paul goes into the next scheduled event, the redemption of our body, and how the Holy Spirit has come to help.

Now let's look at this adoption a little closer in Galatians 3. The Galatians, like the Colossians, were attempting to go back under the law. Paul, having come out from under the law, uses the whole book to teach them. He is saying, "You want to go back under the law and bondage? Listen to me. I came out from underneath the law."

Galatians 3:24 says:

"Wherefore the law was our schoolmaster to bring us unto Christ,
that we might be justified by faith."

The law was a schoolmaster in two areas. First, all its shadows and types pointed to Christ. Second, being spiritually dead, we did not know we were spiritually dead because we were born with that nature. When the law came and said, "Thou shalt not covet," and we tried to stop coveting but could not, the law as a schoolmaster revealed what kind of nature we had and schooled us in the fact that we needed a Redeemer.

Paul continues:

"But after that faith is come,
we are no longer under a schoolmaster.
For ye are all the children of God by faith in Christ Jesus."

If you are Christ's, then you are Abraham's seed and heirs according to the promise.

Then Galatians 4 says:

"Now I say, That the heir,
as long as he is a child,
differeth nothing from a servant,
though he be lord of all."

The margin word is slave. Paul is addressing the law and saying, "You Galatians want to go back under the law. I am a Jew. I came out from under it, so listen to what I have to say."

The Jew was a natural heir to the promise of Abraham. Paul says the natural heir, as long as he is a child, differs nothing from a slave, though he is lord of all. Israel served God as a client nation, served His altars, and was delivered the oracles of God, but they were no different from slaves because they were spiritually dead.

When God settled Romans 7 in my spirit, that it was a spiritually dead Jew who received the law and could not keep it, it opened the book of Romans and the rest of these books. Then I understood statements like this. The natural seed was an heir, but he did not differ from a slave because all were spiritually dead. They were under tutors and governors. The law was a schoolmaster. It schooled them to their death.

When Jesus came, born of a woman and born under the law, He was spiritually alive. He was the first man born on this planet in four thousand years who was spiritually alive. He was the first man qualified to keep the law. He kept it, became a curse for us, fulfilled the law, then stepped into the shoes of every Jew who could not keep it. He freed those who were under the law so they might receive the adoption of sons.

Because you are sons, God has sent forth the Spirit of His Son into your hearts, crying, "Abba, Father." Therefore you are no more a slave, but a son; and if a son, then an heir of God through Christ.

When Paul says, "After you have known God, or rather are known of God, how turn ye again to the weak and beggarly elements?" he is talking about observing days, months, times, and years. We talked about this in detail, and I told you about when I went to Israel. At the table that day were Christian believers keeping the Sabbath and several feast days.

I wanted to be civil, and I kept my tongue until one woman said, "I just feel more complete." That was it. I should have had more mercy, but I could not help it.

The first thing I started with was the Sabbath. It was a type of being born again. That is why they could not work on the Sabbath day, could not even pick up a stick for firewood, or they would be stoned. Because it is not by works, lest any man should boast. This rest you entered into when you came out from underneath the load of sin cannot be bought or purchased. It is by the blood of Jesus.

That is what the Sabbath is a type of. The man who picked up the stick was saying, "I can be saved by my work." But you cannot.

The Sabbath is perpetual, yes. You were born again. It became perpetual. He is Lord of the Sabbath every day, Lord of my rebirth. I celebrate it every day. I live in it. I went to inheritance. I quit working.

Colossians 2:15 says:

"And having spoiled principalities and powers,
he made a shew of them openly,
triumphing over them in it."

Then Paul says:

"Let no man therefore judge you in meat,
or in drink,
or in respect of an holyday,
or of the new moon,
or of the sabbath days:
Which are a shadow of things to come;
but the body is of Christ."

You are not under the law anymore, not in food, drink offerings, harvest days, new moons, or Sabbaths. They were shadows of things to come, but the body making the shadow is Christ.

It is impossible to be in the shadow and in the thing making it at the same time. They touch, but they do not occupy each other. Israel lived in the shadow. When that which made the shadow came, there was no more shadow. I have been born again.

As long as the shadow was being performed on the earth--the tabernacle, sacrifices, feast days, Sabbaths, holy days, and offerings--they were nothing more than a shadow of the things to come, which was sonship. But where there is a shadow, there has to be something making the shadow. In one respect, when God employed Israel as a client nation to serve His altars, their creating the shadow was the faith He needed in the earth to bring into the earth the One making the shadow, Jesus Christ.

You can see that a deceptive spirit is in the earth today. It gets people fifteen or twenty degrees off, and they feel so holy.

I remember a woman in Brazil with a national ministry. When I first met her eight or nine years ago, she brought television equipment to the services and wanted to film and run some of them. We said no. It was a meeting for preachers, and we were getting into things heavy for those preachers. Besides, there was a stigma at that time that all Americans did was come and film and raise money.

She came to several meetings, and one day I had a vision. I saw Satan standing in front of her, buffeting her, and I saw her reasonings being destroyed. We went out to eat, and I wept and cried and said, "Please."

She said, "Oh no, I am aware of his devices."

I said, "Please. When he comes, he never comes as himself. His strength is you not recognizing him."

About two years later, she turned the lights out, began keeping the Sabbath and other holy days, and began preaching other things. When you get off two or three degrees, just as revelation is built foundation upon foundation, deception is built upon deception. When you fall to a deception, it becomes a foundation for more and more because that part of the building has no true foundation. The devil can build almost anything he wants on it.

But I will tell you this as a son: you have a Teacher. God sent Him to seal your inheritance. He is the Enforcer. One of the first things He does as a Lawyer is step in and argue your rights for you in your spirit every time you pray in tongues. Every time. He will make sure deception is aborted if you trust in the praying, no matter what your emotions say. Get out of bed every day and do it anyway, and you will come out of it.

The thing with the Holy Ghost as your Teacher is that when the devil throws a dart, you know it is wrong. If the Holy Spirit is not your Teacher, error can get in. One day a man can teach something wonderful, and the next day something horrible. If the Holy Ghost is your Teacher, even the smallest dart that shoots through your spirit will make you say, "I know this is not right."

That cleared something up for me: how a man could teach abounding revelation knowledge one day and have you on the edge of your seat, and the next day teach something absolutely insulting to the Word of God and the nature of your Father. Why? Because the Holy Ghost is not his Teacher. His intellect is his teacher. Then you are at the mercy of your own reasoning processes, and those can be affected by many factors.

People say, "When I sit under somebody, I just spit the sticks out." That may be okay, but what am I paying you for if I have to guard against what you are telling me? If I am working twelve or fourteen hours a day, sending my wife out to work, giving the children to someone else to watch, and trying to keep up with creature comforts, then this man is pastoring me. If I am working that long, there had better not be sticks in the message.

Thank God for our Teacher, the earnest of our inheritance, the seal unto the redemption of the purchased possession, which is me: spirit, soul, and body. If you get to know Him well here, that is all you will live for.

Now let's go to John 8 and seal this. Beginning in verse 29:

"And he that sent me is with me:
the Father hath not left me alone;
for I do always those things that please him."

As He spoke these words, many believed on Him. Then Jesus said to those Jews who believed on Him:

"If ye continue in my word,
then are ye my disciples indeed;
and ye shall know the truth,
and the truth shall make you free."

We often preach that verse across every aspect of redemption, and the fruit of that is true. If we continue in His Word about healing, we will know the truth and it will make us free. If we continue in His Word about prosperity, we will know the truth and it will make us free.

But in context, He is talking in particular to the Jews, and to the Pharisees who began to believe on Him. He saw a ray of hope and said, "If you continue in what I am saying, I am going to die, go through the cross, rise, and you will know the truth, and it will make you free."

That did it. They said:

"We be Abraham's seed,
and were never in bondage to any man:
how sayest thou,
Ye shall be made free?"

Jesus answered:

"Verily, verily, I say unto you,
Whosoever committeth sin is the servant of sin."

The heir, the Jew, was no different than the slave while he was under tutors and governors. Jesus had to come, born of a woman and born under the law, to free those under the law so they could receive the adoption of sons.

They said, "We are Abraham's seed. We have never been in bondage."

Jesus said, in effect, "You may be the heir, but as long as you sin, that is who you are the slave of. I do not care if you are a Jew. I do not care if you are Abraham's seed. He that sins is the slave of sin."

Then He proved the point:

"And the servant abideth not in the house for ever:
but the Son abideth ever.
If the Son therefore shall make you free,
ye shall be free indeed."

You have been called to My altars and to serve in My house, He was saying, but the slave will not live in the house forever. The Son, the one who has the inheritance of the Father, abides forever. If the Son sets you free, you shall be free indeed, because you will be born again.

You are free at last. You are a son. You have an inheritance. The Father wants to pour inheritance out on you, especially to do the work that needs to be done in the earth. He wants to give you the fattest pound that ever fell out of a man's pocket.

But you have to take the Holy Spirit as your Teacher. He is the only One who can do it for you. Otherwise your reasonings get destroyed, you create religion, you pass by the power of God, and you do not have revival. He has come to teach you. He is your Administrator. He is your earnest.

Let Him teach you who you are until you believe enough to do something in this earth. Do not live under the present bondage. Get it out of your body. Get it out of your finances. Get it out of your life.

You are the son of God.

Let's look at this from Hebrews. Hebrews 1 begins:

"God, who at sundry times and in divers manners spake in time past unto the fathers by the prophets,
Hath in these last days spoken unto us by his Son,
whom he hath appointed heir of all things,
by whom also he made the worlds;
Who being the brightness of his glory,
and the express image of his person,
and upholding all things by the word of his power,
when he had by himself purged our sins,
sat down on the right hand of the Majesty on high;
Being made so much better than the angels,
as he hath by inheritance obtained a more excellent name than they."

He obtained a more excellent name than the angels by inheritance. Then the chapter shows how:

"For unto which of the angels said he at any time,
Thou art my Son,
this day have I begotten thee?"

In other words, "This day you have been born by Me or of Me." To which angel did He ever say, "I will be to Him a Father, and He shall be to Me a Son"? When He brings the Firstbegotten into the world, He says, "Let all the angels of God worship Him." Of the angels He says, "Who maketh his angels spirits, and his ministers a flame of fire."

To the Son He said, "Today You are My Son, because today You have been born." To the angels He says, "He maketh his angels spirits." They were created. Jesus was born. They were created; we were born.

The reason angels cannot give Him what you can is because they were created, and you were born. You are His sons and daughters. You are His family. You have a nature like His, and He can derive from you what He cannot from an angel. You can give Him what they cannot.

They were created in full service, full size, in different classes, as ministers and flames of fire, created for those who shall be heirs of salvation. That is us. They were created; we were born.

Hebrews 2:11 says:

"For both he that sanctifieth
and they who are sanctified
are all of one:
for which cause he is not ashamed to call them brethren."

He that sanctifies is Jesus. They who are sanctified are us. We are all of one. As the Father has life within Himself, He gave to the Son to have life within Himself, and the Son who sanctifies gave that life to us, to have life within ourselves.

He that sanctifies and they who are sanctified are all of one, the Father. For this reason He is not ashamed to call us His brothers. Today He called Him His Son, because that day He had been born from the life that is in the Father. But to angels He said, "He maketh his angels spirits." Every one was created full size for service, but not you and me.

We obtained a more excellent name. To which of the angels did He ever say they were sons, born of His life? They were created. We were born.

He that sanctifies is Jesus, because He paid the price for us to be sanctified. They who are sanctified are us. We are all of one, and the one is the Father. For this reason He is not ashamed to look at me and say, "We have the same Father. We have the same inheritance. I am not ashamed to call you My brethren," because we have been quickened together with Him and seated in heavenly places.

What He is trying to get over to us now is this: do you not understand that you can have the inheritance pertaining to this dispensation? Our adoption process has given us a spirit with His nature in it, with a glorified body pending. He has left us here in Christ's stead to carry on the ministry of reconciliation.

That is really giving us a chance to sit down next to Him and reign, because we took the inheritance He gave us here, reigned unlimited with it, went after the lost brethren of Ham, Shem, and Japheth, swept them into the kingdom, sanctified them through the blood of Jesus, made them sons and daughters of God, finished our work, sat down next to Jesus with a glorified body, and began to reign forever.

I get that chance here. But I have to understand that I have been born from above. God is my Father. In the truest sense, I have the wealth and glory of the inheritance from heaven by Him who has sanctified me and unashamedly called me His brother, and met my needs with the inheritance of heaven to carry out the work here.

I am not ashamed to step forward and say so. I am not a beggar. I am the brother of Jesus' glorified humanity.

I am so glad that when the love of money had me, God stopped me and began to mortify and kill the love of money. I would not have called it that then. I would have called it prosperity. But your prosperity begins with your first level of peace, when you lose your torment.

I am so glad I stopped. Had I stayed out there, I would have done an acceptable work, but I would never have seen the creative side of God's nature. I would never have gotten to see the things I am beginning to see now.

Why? The love of money is the root of all evil. That does not just mean you will connive and scheme to get money. If you are loose enough to use God's people, then usually you have roots feeding other things in your character that are equally bad.

I am glad He killed that enough in me that my faith began to make the transition it needed to understand inheritance.

Jesus said you cannot serve two masters. You cannot serve God and mammon. Of all the things He could list as the two masters, He listed mammon right up there with Himself: God and money. He said you cannot have two people dictating to you what you will and will not do.

I thought serving mammon was the person who tramples over anybody, like those who will to be rich at the hurt and detriment of everyone around them, piercing themselves through with many arrows. I thought that was the mastery and control of money.

But I found out there are two ways to serve mammon.

Let's say God called you to a strong ministry, called you to win Mexico or something, but you never could go. You could not even finish your training. Then one day you stand before Him, and He shows you what He laid out for you.

"This was yours, but you do not have any of it."

You say, "You do not understand. I could not make it there. I tried, but I did not have the money. I could not support my family. It is not that I did not try."

He says, "I love you. We are going to burn the trash. It is okay." It is not that you did not make it to heaven. It is incredible that His last great act of mercy follows us all the way to the judgment seat of Christ.

Jesus said if any man builds upon this foundation, Jesus crucified, and puts on that foundation hay, wood, and stubble, everything built incorrectly will be tried by fire. But he himself shall be saved. That last great act of mercy and grace burns every failure and every unrepented sin that did not take our salvation away. The blood follows us there even, and we get to go in.

But if you look at that half of Mexico He offered you as a reward and say, "I could not do it because I did not have the money. I could not even finish my training because I did not have the money," He will say, "That is strange, because I took your poverty. Sorry, son, that is not good enough."

So I served money by the lack of it and by not getting done what He wanted done. Yes, your master money stood up and said, "You do not have me, and you will not get it done."

You want to bet? I am still breathing, and I am finishing my training.

He that sanctifies and they who are sanctified are both of one, the Father. For this reason He is not ashamed to call me His brother.

Hebrews 2 says:

"For both he that sanctifieth
and they who are sanctified
are all of one:
for which cause he is not ashamed to call them brethren,
Saying, I will declare thy name unto my brethren,
in the midst of the church will I sing praise unto thee.
And again, I will put my trust in him.
And again, Behold I and the children which God hath given me."

As much then as the children are partakers of flesh and blood, He also Himself likewise took part of the same, that through death He might destroy him who had the power of death, that is, the devil, and deliver those who through fear of death were all their lifetime subject to bondage.

Backing up to verse 10 shows how He did this:

"For it became him,
for whom are all things,
and by whom are all things,
in bringing many sons unto glory,
to make the captain of their salvation perfect through sufferings."

Jesus was the Captain of our salvation. He captained our salvation by putting us in a boat. The boat was full of spiritual death, and He got in it Himself and piloted the ship into His own death. Through His own sufferings, He became the Captain of our salvation. He went ahead of us and piloted the boat that brought us out on the other side, born again, called His brothers, sanctified by the blood of Jesus.

So He has, by inheritance, obtained a more excellent name than the angels. They were created. You were born. He is calling you His brethren.